



AGENT ARCHITECTURE

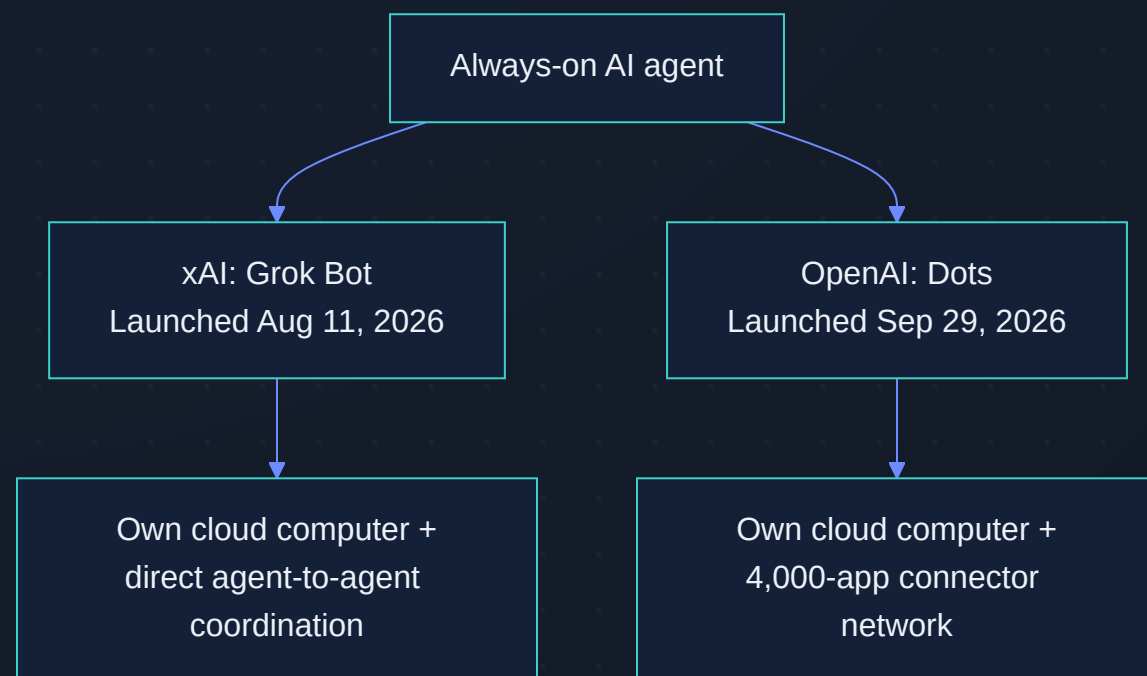
Two AI labs shipped the same idea, seven weeks apart.

xAI's Grok Bot and OpenAI's Dots both give an agent its own cloud computer. The architecture choices underneath are where they actually diverge.





Same Core Idea, Two Different Builds



Where They Actually Differ



Grok Bot treats multi-agent coordination as a first-class feature — bots message each other directly, pass work, and assign ownership inside shared group chats.



Grok Bot is built to operate tools that have no clean API or MCP support — closer to general computer-use automation than a curated integration list.



Dots leans on OpenAI's existing plugin ecosystem — 4,000+ pre-built app connectors instead of raw computer-use — tighter integrations, narrower reach.



Dots is reachable from more surfaces at launch — ChatGPT, Slack, Microsoft Teams, with phone audio coming soon — a distribution edge, not an architecture one.





49 Days

Between the two launches

xAI shipped Grok Bot on August 11, 2026. OpenAI shipped Dots at DevDay on September 29, 2026 — the same core bet (give an agent its own persistent cloud computer) from two competing labs, seven weeks apart.



What This Means If You're Building Agents

- 01 Give your own agents a persistent compute environment, not just stateless API calls — both labs converged on this independently, which is a real signal, not a coincidence.
- 02 Direct agent-to-agent messaging (not just user-mediated handoffs) is worth studying if you're designing a multi-agent system — Grok Bot's group-chat coordination model is a real reference point.
- 03 Curated connectors vs. raw computer-use is a build-vs-integrate tradeoff you'll hit too: broader instant reach vs. deeper flexibility on tools with no API.
- 04 Neither lab has published hard reliability or cost numbers yet. Treat vendor agent-autonomy claims as directional until you've actually tested them on your own workload.





Test the claims before you trust the demo.

Both products are days old. Follow for the actual head-to-head once there's real usage data to compare.

